COMPUTATIONAL THINKING · WEEK 1

A 5-step checklist for any pseudocode question

Use it on every CT question. It finds the bug fast.

THE CHECKLIST

Steps 1 to 3

1 **Start value**

0 for a count or sum. A large value for min. True/False for a flag.

2 **Update**

+ 1 counts. + X.field adds. = X.field keeps max, min or last seen.

3 **Filter**

List every condition. Check and/or, and > vs ≥.

THE CHECKLIST

Steps 4 and 5

4

Scope

Reset inside the outer loop? Then it holds only one card's value.

5

Dry-run

Run 3–4 cards in a table, one column per variable.

EXAM TIP

Options often differ by one thing only.

Check these three first: > vs ≥, 'and' vs 'or', first vs last.

TRAPS

Bugs the options love

⚠ min = 0 bug: no mark is below 0, so min never changes. Start min large (100 for marks).

⚠ > keeps the first maximum. ≥ keeps the last.

⚠ Initialise before the loop, not inside it.

⚠ No 'Move X to Table 2' means the loop never ends.

Practise real Qualifier PYQs free.

Timed mocks on the real exam screen, graded with the official answer keys.

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